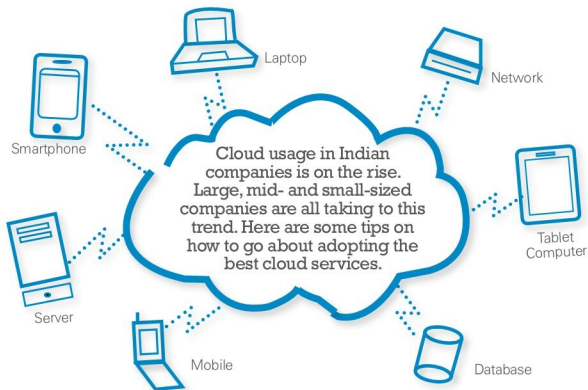


How to Choose the Best Cloud Solution



India is becoming more cloud-ready with every passing day. Large enterprises and SMEs are warming up to this phenomenon called the cloud. According to the recently released third annual VMware Cloud Index, a commissioned study conducted in 11 Asia Pacific countries by Forrester Consulting and ITR, cloud usage in India has surged. Fifty per cent of the respondents in the country stated that they have already adopted cloud solutions or approaches, which is a growth of about 25 per cent over last year. An additional 30 per cent of the respondents declared that they are currently planning to deploy cloud solutions within the next 18 months, highlighting the growing cloud opportunities in India. However, 40 per cent of respondents state that there is internal resistance to change that is hindering the adoption of the cloud, suggesting that faster cloud adoption is possible for Indian organisations if these hindrances can be overcome.

"The survey demonstrates the potential for cloud computing in the country and reflects a double digit rate of adoption," said T Srinivasan, managing director, VMware India and SAARC. The study also reveals that 54 per cent

of senior IT professionals surveyed in India consider cloud computing as a top business priority. There has also been an improvement in the understanding of cloud computing with 72 per cent of respondents claiming a good understanding, compared to 59 per cent last year. Knowledge about cloud computing is higher in large organisations (10,000+ employees: 82 per cent) compared to small organisations (<500 employees: 63 per cent).

It is the lack of knowledge about the cloud that is deterring the small and medium enterprises in the country to migrate to it. *Open Source For You* spoke to a few industry giants to gather tips on how to choose the best cloud solution.

Determine the profile of the application that one wants to host on the cloud

Before a firm begins looking for a cloud solution, the decision makers should be sure of the profile of the application that they want to host on the cloud. Arvind Mehrotra, president, Asia Pacific and Middle East, NIIT Technologies Ltd, says, "First, one has to understand the load of an application. The applications that require high-peak loads and larger scale